PARTNERS of the AMERICAS
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# 2019 Administrative Guide

Last Revised August 2019.

This manual has been prepared to help you become acquainted with Partners' procedures and administrative procedures, and to answer questions common to new and continuing employees. Feel free to ask for any additional information from your supervisor or from the Finance Office.

Periodic revisions are expected. Questions and suggestions are welcome and should be provided to the Finance and Administration Office. Employees are free to ask about interpretations or to suggest changes at any time. Partners' reserves the right to revise any procedure or guideline described in this document without notice.

Thank you!



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# Table of Contents


**TRAVEL RELATED ..... 7**

**Staff Travel Guidelines ..... 7**

**1. Objective ..... 7**

**2. Financial Goal ..... 7**

**3. Traveler Definitions ..... 7**

**4. Applicability of Policy ..... 7**

**5. Requesting Authorization ..... 8**
5.1 Use of Travel Authorizations ..... 8
5.1.1 Use of Travel Authorizations – HQ Staff, Consultants, Volunteers, etc. (Based in the US) ..... 8
5.1.2 Use of Travel Authorizations – Field Staff & Local Consultants (Based outside of the US) ..... 8
5.1.3 Travelers Insurance – HQ Staff, Consultants, Volunteers, etc. (Based in the US) ..... 9
5.2 Changes to Itineraries ..... 9

**6. Travel Advances (Only Applicable to HQ Staff) ..... 10**

**7. Allowable and Unallowable Expenses (Applicable to All) ..... 10**
7.1 Allowable expenses and reimbursement limitations ..... 10
7.1.1 Lodging – Reimbursable Based ..... 10
7.1.2 Rental Cars – Reimbursable Based ..... 11
7.1.3 Use of Personal Vehicle – Reimbursable Based ..... 11
7.1.4 Tolls, Parking, Etc. – Reimbursable Based ..... 11
7.1.5 Airfare and Trains – Reimbursable Based ..... 11
7.1.5.1 Seat Upgrades ..... 11
7.1.5.2 Fly America Act ..... 12
7.1.6 Meals & Incidentals (M&IE) – Per Diem Based ..... 13
7.1.7 All Other Miscellaneous Travel Expenses (MTE) – Reimbursable Based ..... 13
7.2 Unallowable expenses and reimbursement limitations ..... 14
7.2.1 Alcohol Purchases ..... 14
7.2.2 Personal Purchases on Corporate Credit Cards ..... 14
7.2.3 Other Unallowable Expenses ..... 14

**8. Per Diem for M&IE ..... 15**
8.1 Per Diem General Guidelines ..... 15





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8.1.1 M&IE rates ..... 15
8.1.2 M&IE meal breakdown ..... 15
8.1.3 M&IE allowable costs ..... 16
8.1.4 M&IE weekend travel ..... 17
8.2 Per Diem M&IE – US Based/HQ ..... 17
8.3 Per Diem M&IE – Local Field Office Staff – Non-US Based ..... 17
8.4 Per Diem M&IE – US Based/Other ..... 18
8.5 Payment of Per Diems ..... 18
8.5.1 Per Diem Payment for Local Field Office Staff (Non-US Based) ..... 18
8.5.2 Per Diem Payment for US Based/HQ and US Based/Other ..... 18

**9. Reimbursement Requests (Non-Per Diem Items) ..... 19**
9.1 Expense Reports for Reimbursement – US Based/US and US Based/Other ..... 19
9.2 Expense Reports for Reimbursement – Local Field Office Staff (Based outside of the US) ..... 19

**10. Personal Travel during Business Trips ..... 19**

**11. Travel/Trip Reports ..... 20**

**12. Partners HQ Travel Agency – Travel Leaders Corporate ..... 20**

**13. Travel Audits ..... 20**

**14. Policy Oversight ..... 21**

**15. Travel Policy Education ..... 21**

**16. Out of Policy Safeguard ..... 21**

**DOCUMENTS: E-DOC NOMENCLATURE (NAMING CONVENTION) ..... 21**

**Policy ..... 21**
Procedure ..... 21

**STAFF & EMPLOYMENT ..... 23**

**Communicating Absences ..... 23**
Updating voicemail ..... 23
Automatic reply ..... 23
Staff calendar ..... 23
Late arrivals ..... 24



1424 K Street NW Suite 700 Washington DC 20005 202.628.3300 www.partners.net

**Hiring of New Staff and/or Consultants** ..... **24**
Staff ..... 24
Consultants ..... 24

**New Staff Orientation** ..... **25**

**Staff Development** ..... **25**

**Performance Evaluation** ..... **26**

**FINANCIAL** ..... **26**

**Grant Numbers and Line Items** ..... **26**

**Check Requests** ..... **26**

**ACH Requests** ..... **27**

**Wire Transfer Requests** ..... **28**

**PayPal or Western Union Requests** ..... **28**

**American Express, VISA and Corporate Cards** ..... **29**

**Procurement Policies and Procedures** ..... **29**

**Petty Cash** ..... **30**

**COMMUNICATIONS** ..... **30**

**Partners Logos** ..... **30**

**External Communication & Publications** ..... **30**
News releases ..... 30
Stored publications ..... 31

**Web** ..... **31**

**Business Cards** ..... **31**

**Pins** ..... **31**



1424 K Street NW Suite 700 Washington DC 20005 202.628.3300 www.partners.net

**OFFICE & EQUIPMENT** ..... 31

**Phones** ..... 31
Logging in / out of phones ..... 32
Outgoing calls ..... 32
Incoming calls ..... 32
Main line ..... 32
Transferring calls ..... 32
Unlocking the elevator ..... 32
Conference calls ..... 32
Voicemail ..... 33
Offsite voicemail access ..... 33

**Office Supplies Purchases** ..... 33

**Printers & Copiers** ..... 33
Printer settings ..... 33
Sending faxes ..... 34
Scanning ..... 34

**Computer Support** ..... 34
New users ..... 37
Guest user ..... 37
Wireless internet ..... 37
Shared address book(s) and distribution lists ..... 37
Read-Only Folder ..... 37
Database ..... 38

**Security** ..... 38
Elevators ..... 38
Alarm ..... 38
Safety ..... 39

**Conference Room** ..... 39

**Kitchen Duty** ..... 40

**Green Initiatives** ..... 40
Email signature ..... 40
Lights ..... 40
Recycle ..... 40
Reuse ..... 41



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Set your printing defaults ..... 41

**CONTRACTS ..... 41**

**Templates ..... 41**

**Process ..... 42**

**Policy & Procedure, Authorized Agreement Signatory Approvers ..... 42**
Purpose ..... 42
Effective Date ..... 42
Policy: Signatory Approvers ..... 43
Types of AGREEMENTS requiring approval ..... 43
Approved Scenarios ..... 43
Cover Sheet Approval Procedure ..... 43

**ANNEX A: PER DIEM EXAMPLES ..... 45**

**ANNEX B: AFFIDAVIT IN LIEU OF RECEIPT ..... 47**

**ANNEX C: TRAVEL REPORT TEMPLATE ..... 48**

**ANNEX D: 2 CFR PART 200: UNALLOWABLE COSTS ..... 49**



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# Travel Related

## Staff Travel Guidelines

### 1. Objective

The objective of this policy is to manage a travel process fully compliant with the 2 CFR 200 and Partners' rules and regulations with guidance from U.S. Government procedures.

### 2. Financial Goal

The financial goal of this policy is to increase accountability and efficiency of travel expenditures and to ensure compliance throughout the full process of USG regulations, 2 CFR 200, and other applicable laws, including timely clearance of all travel reports (credit card reports, expense reports, and per diem payments).

### 3. Traveler Definitions

Partners' travel policy is broken out based on three traveler types. All travelers are expected to comply with and follow the provisions in their respective categories as follows:

- US based/HQ
  - US based/HQ are all individuals with their principle desk location at HQ.
  - This includes but is not limited to:
    - HQ Staff
    - Consultants
    - Interns
    - Telecommuting employees, etc.
- Local Field Office staff
  - Local field staff are those on payroll at Partners field offices, including the Country Director
  - Local consultant based abroad are consultants paid directly by the field office
  - All other local travelers
- US based/Other
  - Including but not limited to volunteers, board members, etc.

### 4. Applicability of Policy

This policy applies to US based/HQ and Other staff unless otherwise indicated below. Specific guidance at a country and project level may be prepared on a case-by-case basis and approved by the President's Council managing supervisor and the CFO or CEO. In no event, shall these country or project-specific policies be out of compliance with the procedures and cost/time values identified herein.


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## 5. Requesting Authorization

Staff and consultants considering a trip must discuss with their supervisor the need for the trip, activities to be conducted, funding for related costs, expectations, etc. (Partners' President will notify the Board about their travel plans).

For all travelers including staff, consultants, volunteers and others traveling under Partners funding, a travel authorization must be prepared prior to travel and booking of flights, hotels, etc.

### 5.1 Use of Travel Authorizations

#### *5.1.1 Use of Travel Authorizations – HQ Staff, Consultants, Volunteers, etc. (Based in the US)*

All travelers must submit a Travel Authorization (TA) in the Salesforce platform and obtain authorization from supervisors for all Partners travel. This includes any travel outside of HQ (Washington DC/DMV area) or the respective Country Field Office (including city location of country field office) with travel duration of four (4) hours or longer, regardless of the destination or transportation mode. All records and TAs will be stored electronically on Salesforce. For staff, consultants, volunteers, etc., without access to Salesforce, an alternative platform/form can be utilized if approved by the CFO.

Prior to any flight, hotel, train, and other bookings with Partners HQ's travel agency, the agency will require an approved TA for all travelers before processing the request. Proper TA's must include the following:

- Traveler's Full Name on Passport
- Address
- Gender
- Date of Birth
- Program/Administration Unit Traveling Under
- Purpose of the Trip/ Scope of Work to be Performed
- Dates of Travel
- Proposed Itinerary
- Approval Authorization from Supervisor

For HQ staff, the supervisor granting approval for the trip must ensure that proper procedures related to travel notification/approvals from funding agencies are followed. All travel plans for HQ staff should be entered into the Staff Calendar on Outlook.

#### *5.1.2 Use of Travel Authorizations – Field Staff & Local Consultants (Based outside of the US)*

All field staff and local consultants are required to complete a travel authorization, using the standard template/platform for Field Office staff travel, and receive approval from their respective supervisors. For travel


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authorization processes, please refer to the specific country's supplemental field office manual. At a minimum, the TA should include the following:

- Traveler's Full Name on official government ID (e.g., Passport)
- Purpose of the Trip/ Scope of Work to be Performed
- Dates of Travel
- Proposed Itinerary
- Signature of Authorization from Supervisor

#### *5.1.3 Travelers Insurance – HQ Staff, Consultants, Volunteers, etc. (Based in the US)*

For travel within the US, travel insurance through AIG will also be requested online via Salesforce. Note that only consultants, volunteers, etc. should request travel insurance through AIG, as all HQ staff are insured by our corporate international travel insurance. AIG travel insurance is only available to travelers coming from or to the United States. Travelers going between countries outside of the US must find an alternative plan (e.g. Seven Corners Insurance).

Once a TA form is requested through Salesforce, an electronic copy of the insurance request will be sent to the HQ Finance Office. Once the HQ Finance Office completes enrollment, the HQ staff member, requesting insurance for their travelers, will receive an electronic confirmation email.

### 5.2 Changes to Itineraries

The appropriate supervisor should approve the traveler's itinerary changes. After receiving approval from the supervisor, travelers can contact the appropriate agency to make the necessary changes. Most importantly, it is critical that the supervisor notifies the respective Finance Office (whether in field office or at HQ), to ensure that the per diem amount or other changes can be made as necessary. In emergency circumstances, when a supervisor is not available or after hour changes must be made immediately, it is left to the discretion of the travelers. However, they are required to notify their supervisor once the change(s) have been made. Note that the supervisor reserves the right to not approve the change. In such instance, the traveler will be responsible for any difference in cost associated with the change. Disagreements will be resolved by the CFO.

When appropriate and once travel authorization has been approved and a draft itinerary established, HQ staff will notify senior management of pending travel plans via email **2 weeks prior to travel** (or as soon as possible for urgent travel) to enable staff to provide input on the traveler's itinerary in furtherance of Partners' business development objectives. For example, staff visiting a USAID Mission in country X to promote a program might be encouraged to pay courtesy calls on key USG personnel to promote additional Partners programs.


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## 6. Travel Advances (Only Applicable to HQ Staff)

As travel per diems will be provided, all travelers can request their per diem payment prior to the trip's departure date. However, in certain circumstances, only HQ staff can request a staff travel advances for additional, necessary cash outside of the established per diem rates. Any HQ staff travel advance must be requested before a trip and in accordance with Partners payment processing cycle. The request must include justification and the amount requested. The request must be accompanied by an approved TA. Advance will be limited to 75% of the total M&IE estimated amount. All advances should be cleared 30 days from the issue date, unless the travel period extends beyond two weeks in which case, the staff member has 60 days to clear the advance.

## 7. Allowable and Unallowable Expenses (Applicable to All)

The following allowable and unallowable expenses apply to all Partners travelers regardless of their relationship or the location of their base.

### 7.1 Allowable expenses and reimbursement limitations

Partners has a travel policy that provides a per diem for all Meals & Incidental Expenses (M&IE), while all other miscellaneous travel expenses, lodging, rental cars, personal vehicles, airfare and train costs are reimbursed based upon actual expenses incurred. Allowable expenses are also limited to the conditions established on grants and agreements with funding agencies sponsoring the trip.

Furthermore, only allowable expenses are reimbursable under the category other miscellaneous travel expenses, lodging, rental cars, personal vehicles, airfare and trains. No later than 30 days following the final day of a trip, an Expense Reimbursement Report should be prepared and submitted to the traveler's respective Finance Office (whether in field or at HQ). Partners will not accept reimbursement requests made after 60 days unless approved by Senior Management at HQ. All travelers requesting an exception must make their requests in writing with a valid reason for the delay.

#### *7.1.1 Lodging – Reimbursable Based*

Lodging is defined as room charges and taxes. For reimbursement purposes, a receipt must be provided. These charges cannot include room service fees, upgrade fees, mini bar tabs, entertainment fees, etc. All of these other expenditures must be paid by the traveler using their personal or per diem funds and excluded from their lodging bill.

Partners will recognize and reimburse lodging costs based on actual expenses, but the USG ceiling rates shall be a guide to appropriate expenditures per country and must not be exceeded. Exceptions above the maximum rate can be approved by the CFO or CEO. A list of USG guidance is provided below:

- General Services Administration (GSA) establishes per diem rates for destinations within the lower 48 Continental United States (CONUS).


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- The Department of Defense (DOD) establishes non-foreign rates which includes Alaska, Hawaii, and all U.S. Territories (Non-CONUS).
- The State Department establishes all foreign rates which are specific to major cities.

#### *7.1.2 Rental Cars – Reimbursable Based*

The cost of rental cars including rental car insurance is allowed only if the nature of the trip or the location of business to be visited is such, that use of field transport or local transportation is unavailable, impractical or unsafe, as determined by the traveler's supervisor. If deemed necessary and approved as part of the TA process, Partners will recognize and reimburse rental car costs based on actual expenses. Prior to reimbursement, the respective Finance Office (whether in the field or at HQ), will need to check that the TA includes an explanation (specific uses) as to why a car rental was necessary.

Note, Partners does not carry a blanket collision damage waiver policy nor is the traveler covered with liability insurance if collision with the rental vehicle were to occur. Partners recommends the purchase of collision and liability insurance each time a car is rented.

#### *7.1.3 Use of Personal Vehicle – Reimbursable Based*

The use of a personal vehicle while on travel within the US is permitted in lieu of airline transportation if approved by the supervisor. The traveler will be reimbursed for gas mileage in accordance with the IRS standard mileage rate. The current mileage reimbursement is $0.58 cent per mile driven for business purposes https://www.irs.gov/newsroom/irs-issues-standard-mileage-rates-for-2019

#### *7.1.4 Tolls, Parking, Etc. – Reimbursable Based*

For business travel, if renting a car, using a personal vehicle or using a Partners' program vehicle, Partners will reimburse based on actual costs for all tolls, parking and other costs associated to the use of the vehicle. These types of expenditures are reimbursed based on actual charges incurred and a receipt must be provided for expenses over $25.

#### *7.1.5 Airfare and Trains – Reimbursable Based*

Partners will reimburse or purchase on behalf of all approved travelers all necessary airfare and train tickets. For reimbursement purposes, a receipt and boarding pass must be provided for all airfare and train tickets. Please note below the additional restrictions related to airfare purchases.

##### *7.1.5.1 Seat Upgrades*

Only coach class or promotional fares will be paid by Partners. Business and first class are considered seat upgrades and must follow the below protocol; otherwise, this will not be covered by Partners. While seat upgrades are not to be expected, there are some circumstances when the traveler could be authorized to travel Business class:


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- When no space is available in coach-class accommodation and the particular flight must be taken
- When use of business class is necessary to accommodate traveler disability or a special need
- When the cost is the same or the traveler pays for the difference in cost between coach and the upgrade

With the exception of no-cost upgrades, or the traveler pays for the difference in cost without Partners' funding, all seat upgrades will need to be approved in advance with the CEO or CFO at HQ (for HQ staff, consultant and volunteers based in the US) and with the Country Director (for all field staff and local consultants) and must include a written justification as to why the upgrade is necessary.

#### *7.1.5.2 Fly America Act*

All US government-funded travel will comply with the Fly America Act, which requires that all travel and shipments must be made on U.S. flag carriers to the extent services by such carriers is available. Use of a Fly America compliant carrier is required regardless of whether a foreign carrier can provide the service at a comparable or lower cost, or whether a foreign carrier is preferred due to convenience. The rules generally provide for a limited number of exceptions; however, a U.S. carrier must be used for any travel: 1) within the U.S., or 2) between the U.S. and the last destination point that is served by a U.S. carrier for that particular routing. Exceptions to the Fly America Act can only be approved by Partners CFO at HQ. The exceptions are as listed below:

1. If a U.S. flag air carrier offers nonstop or direct service (no aircraft change) from your origin to your destination, you must use the U.S. flag air carrier service unless such use would extend your travel time, including delay at origin, by 24 hours or more.
2. If a U.S. flag air carrier does not offer nonstop or direct service (no aircraft change) between your origin and your destination, you must use a U.S. flag air carrier on every portion of the route where it provides service unless, when compared to using a foreign air carrier, such use would:
    - Increase the number of aircraft changes you must make outside of the U.S. by 2 or more; or
    - Extend your travel time by at least 6 hours or more; or
    - Require a connecting time of 4 hours or more at an overseas interchange point.

In order for a flight to be in compliance with the Fly America Act, the code of a U.S. flag air carrier must be noted as part of the flight number on the airline ticket, flight coupon (boarding pass), or passenger receipt. Each airline has a two-letter alpha code. From this list, you will be able to compare airline codes on the ticket with those on the list and thereby be able to ascertain whether or not the flight is on a US Flag air carrier. In order to ensure that the flight is Fly America Act compliant all travel should be booked through the designated travel agent/agency.

Many of the U.S. flag air carriers are listed below:


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- AirTran Airways (FL)
- Alaska Airlines (AS)
- American Airlines (AA)
- Continental Airlines (CO)
- Delta Airlines (DL)
- Frontier Airlines (F9)
- Hawaiian Airlines (HA)
- JetBlue Airways (B6)
- Midwest Express (YX)
- Southwest Airlines (WN)
- Spirit Airlines (NK)
- United Airlines (UA)
- US Airways (US)

#### *7.1.6 Meals & Incidentals (M&IE) – Per Diem Based*

Partners includes the cost of all meals and incidentals under a flat rate per diem provided to the traveler and will NOT reimburse based on actual expenditures. Partial per diem will be provided when one or more of the meals is provided by someone other than the traveler.

For the appropriate amount of the per diem, please reference Section 8, Per Diem for M&IE to determine correct per diem based on the traveler type.

#### *7.1.7 All Other Miscellaneous Travel Expenses (MTE) – Reimbursable Based*

All other miscellaneous travel expenses (MTE) are additional expenses and paid as necessary and charged to the POA credit card or reimbursed based on the actual costs incurred. All MTE expenses over $25 must be supported by receipts/stubs/invoices as part of the expense report in order to be reimbursed. MTE includes but is not limited to the following:

- All ground transportation fees (buses, taxis, etc.) between place of lodging or business and places off site to obtain meals, meetings, site visits, etc.
- Visas
- Room cleaning cost: Where an apartment is taken in lieu of hotel accommodations, the traveler may contract, however this must come from the incidental travel expense part of the per diem
- Immunizations and medications on travel
- Reproduction of materials
- Telephone calls and other communication costs that are reasonable and necessary for work-related communications
- Bank fees on exchanges currencies
- Purchase of clothing (in the event that baggage is lost, and clothing must be purchased in order to keep with meeting schedules)



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### 7.2 Unallowable expenses and reimbursement limitations

Partners will not reimburse or cover charges for the below prohibited items. Please note these lists are not inclusive and Partners reserves the right to refuse payment of any authorized or expense deemed unallowable.

#### *7.2.1 Alcohol Purchases*

Alcohol purchases may not be made with Partners' funds while on Partners travel.

In exceptional cases, Director-level HQ staff and above may purchase alcohol for an event or meal when there is clear justification for the alcohol purchases. This will also need approval of the CFO and/or CEO when submitting the expense report. Partners will have to fund these purchases from its internal Administrative Funds as it is an unallowable as a regular program cost. All alcohol purchases made for reasonable Partners business can only be charged under administrative departments to object code 8402 – Unallowable Program Costs. By charging these items to 8402, they will be excluded from any Partners NICRA calculation and thus a hard cost to the Administrative Budget. Please note you will need to split the alcohol from the total bill and exclude the cost (not including tax, unless there is a specific liquor tax).

#### *7.2.2 Personal Purchases on Corporate Credit Cards*

Applicable to all Corporate Cardholders, personal purchases should not be made on corporate credit cards. However, in the event that a mistaken charge is made, the expense should be reimbursed to Partners upon submitting the credit cards statement. On the credit card expense report, the personal expense will be coded to 1201, and the expense must be reimbursed with cash, check, or credit/debit card. If desired to pay via credit/debit card, please let the HQ Finance Office know and they will generate an electronic invoice.

#### *7.2.3 Other Unallowable Expenses*

Partners' unallowable expenses include but are not limited to:

- Additional travel insurance, travel accident insurance or trip cancelation premiums
- Non-essential upgrades or packages
- Additional expenses associated with the cost of first or business class airfare, unless it falls into the exception categories listed above
- Childcare and babysitting expenses
- Costs incurred by your failure to cancel transportation or hotel reservations
- Costs incurred by your spouse or other dependents traveling with you, unless spouse or dependents is also on a Partners assignment
- Gasoline expenses when the automobile mileage reimbursement rate is claimed
- Hair styling and haircut expenses
- Spa, nails or other treatments
- Entertainment or tour expenses, unless activity is required by Partners trip
- Kennel/boarding expenses for pets
- Costs incurred for speeding tickets, etc. when renting or driving any vehicle for Partners use



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- Other expenses not directly related to the business purpose of the travel assignment

For a complete list of unallowable expenses for USG funds, please reference 2 CFR Part 200: Unallowable Costs (Annex D) or OMB Circular A-133, which includes any potential exceptions to the above unallowable expenses.

## 8. Per Diem for M&IE

Partners has a travel policy that provides a per diem for all expenses related to meals and incidental expenses (M&IE). For the appropriate amount of per diem, please determine the traveler type. All travelers will fall into one of the three categories, as defined in Section 3. Traveler Definitions.

### 8.1 Per Diem General Guidelines

#### *8.1.1 M&IE rates*

All Partners' M&IE per diem rates are based on a percentage of the government per diems allowed per city and/or country, as defined herein and below in Sections 8.2, 8.3 and 8.4. Depending on the destination, travelers should utilize the General Service Administration rates for travel within the continental US, the Department of Defense rates for travel to Alaska, Hawaii, and other US territories, and the State Department for all foreign travel. The websites to obtain the rates are listed below:

- General Services Administration (GSA) establishes per diem rates for destinations within the lower 48 Continental United States (CONUS).
- The Department of Defense (DOD) establishes non-foreign rates which includes Alaska, Hawaii, and all U.S. Territories (Non-CONUS).
- The State Department establishes all foreign rates which are specific to major cities.

Per diems are driven based on the approved TA and include any travel outside of HQ or the respective Country Field Office with travel duration of four (4) hours or longer, regardless of the destination or transportation mode. Exceptions to this must be approved by the CEO or CFO.

#### *8.1.2 M&IE meal breakdown*

M&IE is intended to cover the costs of meals and incidentals during each day of work-related travel. For first and last days of travel (travel days), if the itinerary requires the traveler to start their travel day from their home-of-record (or work-related destination) before breakfast and return to their work-related destination (or home-of-record) after dinner, then the full per diem can be recorded and documented in the expense report. Specifically, if departure from home on first day of travel is before 6AM or arrival to home on last day of travel is after 7PM, then full per diem may be applied for a travel day. Otherwise, travel day rates will be determined as defined in Sections 8.2, 8.3 or 8.4.

The travel day rate utilized should be as follows: On first day of travel, utilize the destination city; on the last day of travel, utilize the departure city. For example, if the traveler leaves home-of-record and travels to San


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Diego on day one, and returns back home from San Diego on day three, during both travel days, the per diem should be calculated based on the San Diego rate.

If the daily M&IE rate excludes one or more of the meals, these are to be reduced at the following rates:

- Breakfast: 16% of daily calculated M&IE rate
- Lunch: 24% of daily calculated M&IE rate
- Dinner: 40% of daily calculated M&IE rate
- 

Note that incidentals are calculated at 20% of the total daily rate and excluded from these meal rates; i.e., the sum of incidentals and the three meals is equal to 100% of the daily M&IE.

See examples in Annex A.

#### *8.1.3 M&IE allowable costs*

The M&IE portion is intended to substantially cover the costs as described below.

- The meals allowance portion is intended to include the cost of breakfast, lunch, and dinner while on travel, and is incorporated as part of the per diem.
- Incidental travel expense portion is intended to include but are not limited to:
  - Fees and tips to waiters, porters, baggage handlers, bellhops, hotel servants, dining room stewards, and similar employees
  - Laundry, dry cleaning, and pressing of clothing
  - Room cleaning tips
  - All other incidental travel expenses as defined by Chapter 300, Part 300-3, in the Federal Travel Regulation (www.gsa.gov/ftr), under Per Diem Allowance.

US Based/HQ and local field office staff are not permitted to charge a corporate card for meals covered by their per diem, for themselves or any other individual receiving a Partners' per diem. As all Partners travelers receive some form of per diem, their costs should be paid for separately with per diem or personal funds. However, if the meal for the group is charged on a corporate card, this meal must be deducted from the daily per diem rate, at the rate defined above (in Section 8.1.2 M&IE meal breakdown) for the specified meal.

If US Based/HQ or local field office staff need to cover the cost for meal invitees (e.g. donors, etc.), they may use a corporate card to pay for the bill; however, they should deduct their meal and the meals of any other Partners' per diem recipients from the bill and pay the remaining balance on the corporate card, if possible. Alternatively, they may choose to deduct the meal from the daily per diem rate received, as per the rate defined above for the specified meal. Similarly, when paying with personal credit card or cash (intending to be reimbursed), the US Based/HQ or local field office staff will only receive reimbursement for the portion of the bill that does not include meals for Partners' per diem recipients. If for some reason the bill cannot be split, and there is no other option than to pay on a corporate card, the US Based/HQ or local field office staff member


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must split out the portion of the bill when coding their credit card statement between personal charges and actual business expenses. The US Based/HQ or local field office staff member will be liable to pay Partners back for their part of the meal and for the meals of any other Partners per diem recipient charged to their Partners' corporate credit card if they received an advance for per diem; otherwise, this should be deducted from the expense report when requesting travel per diem after the trip.

#### *8.1.4 M&IE weekend travel*

Should a traveler remain away from home on business over a weekend, the per diem will be allowed, assuming that the traveler is required to be away from home over the weekend for business purposes.

### 8.2 Per Diem M&IE – US Based/HQ

This portion of the per diem policy guidelines applies to all individuals with their principle desk location at HQ. US Based/HQ travelers include but is not limited to HQ Staff, consultants, interns, telecommuting employees, etc. For all full days on travel, **US Based/HQ travelers will receive 90%** of the government per diem rate for the particular city (or region for travel where not all specific cities are listed).

On the first and last day of travel, in alignment with the USG guidelines the M&IE per diem will be based on **67.5%** of the government per diem rate (75% of 90%) for the particular city (or region for travel where not all specific cities are listed). See exceptions to this in Section 8.1 above.

If US Based/HQ travelers are taking personal vacation time either before or after the Partners business travel, they will not receive Partners per diem those days. The US Based/HQ travelers will receive the first and last travel day in accordance with the guidelines listed above, as these US Based/HQ travelers would have had to travel to or from the US whether or not they were on personal travel after or prior to the trip.

### 8.3 Per Diem M&IE – Local Field Office Staff – Non-US Based

This portion of the per diem policy guidelines applies to all local field office staff, local consultants and all other local travelers based outside of the US. This policy includes the Country Director. For all full days on travel, **Local Field Office staff will receive a maximum of 50%** of the government per diem rate for the particular city (or region for travel where not all specific cities are listed). The specific rates will be defined by program personnel and approved by the CFO or CEO.

On the first and last day of travel, in alignment with the USG guidelines, the maximum M&IE per diem will be based on **37.5%** of the government per diem rate for the particular city (or region for travel where not all specific cities are listed). See exceptions to this in Section 8.1 above.

If local field office staff are taking personal vacation time either before or after the Partners business travel, they will not receive Partners per diem those days. The local field office staff will receive the first and last travel day in accordance with the guidelines listed above, as these local field office staff local field office staff would have had to travel to or from the office or place of residency whether or not they were on personal travel after or prior to the trip.



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### 8.4 Per Diem M&IE – US Based/Other

This portion of the per diem policy guidelines apply to all other travelers including but not limited to volunteers, board members and others working for Partners. This includes local office field staff traveling on international travel to the US or other countries.

Staff will adhere to the per diem rates as defined in Section 8.2 Per Diem M&IE – US Based/HQ. A different, lower pre-determined rate can be determined on a case-by-case basis and will require a memo with approval by the managing director and CFO or CEO.

### 8.5 Payment of Per Diems

Regardless of the traveler, per diems will only be paid upon the Finance Office's receipt of an approved TA. The approved TA and itinerary will be the supporting documentation and authorization for the issuance of the per diem. No receipts will be required for per diem payment, except as defined in this policy.

All per diem payments should be made within 30 days from the end date of travel. Partners will not accept per diem payment requests made after 60 days unless approved by Senior Management at HQ. All travelers requesting an exception must make their requests for exceptions in writing (e.g. memorandum addressed to the Finance office) with a valid reason for the delay.

It is the traveler's responsibility to utilize their per diem to cover all of their meals and incidentals. Unless approved by the CEO, no additional M&IE will be provided. The traveler does not need to reimburse the organization if they do not spend all of their daily M&IE.

#### *8.5.1 Per Diem Payment for Local Field Office Staff (Non-US Based)*

Local field office staff including the Country Director and all other local travelers outside of the US will be issued their per diem in accordance with that country's guidelines as indicated in the country specific supplemental manual.

#### *8.5.2 Per Diem Payment for US Based/HQ and US Based/Other*

US Based/HQ and US Based/Other travelers can receive their per diem payment either prior to their trip, or upon their return. Per diem payments either before or after travel will be paid out by check, ACH, wire or prepaid debit cards in accordance with normal Partners HQ payment cycles.

If a per diem is paid prior to departure and for any reason the traveler departs early or ends their assignment early, or some of their meals have been covered by someone other than the traveler, then the traveler is liable to return the per diem amount paid for the days that they are leaving early or for the meals provided. In the event that the traveler is using a prepaid debit card from Partners, the balance will be reduced in accordance with necessary reduction in per diem. If the traveler owes money to Partners for terminating an assignment early for any reason, and they do not have a balance on their prepaid debit card, then that traveler must repay Partners in another method. Partners reserves the right to take all necessary actions to recover per diem funds from early termination of business travel and assignments, up to and including taking the necessary legal action.



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## 9. Reimbursement Requests (Non-Per Diem Items)

Allowable expenses that may be submitted for reimbursement as described above (lodging, rental cars, personal vehicles, airfare and trains) are all reasonable costs which are essential and directly related to the objectives of the grant and/or the main purpose of the trip.

### 9.1 Expense Reports for Reimbursement – US Based/US and US Based/Other

No later than 30 days following the final day of a trip as necessary (in which purchases are not made on behalf of the traveler in advance), a reimbursement request should be prepared and submitted to the Finance Office at HQ. This report should include the following:

- A fully executed Travel Authorization/Travel Itinerary
- An Expense Report which includes all proper documentation, coding and receipts for all items over $25. Country-specific cost rates shall be defined in the country specific supplemental field office manual.
    - Please note that a bank or credit card statement is not sufficient documentation for a receipt. Where sufficient documentation has not been obtained, an affidavit will need to be filled out confirming the expenses were for business purposes and that the expenses did not include any alcohol. A copy of an appropriate affidavit is found in Annex B.
- Provide evidence of the exchange rate during the period of travel (a hotel or bank receipt showing a conversion of currency may be a convenient way of satisfying this requirement.)
    - The following sites are also recommended to utilize for obtaining the exchange rate:
        - Oanda: https://www.oanda.com/currency/converter/
        - XE : https://www.xe.com/

### 9.2 Expense Reports for Reimbursement – Local Field Office Staff (Based outside of the US)

No later than 30 days following a trip as necessary (in which purchases are not made on behalf of the traveler in advance), a reimbursement request should be prepared and submitted to the Field Finance Office in country. The method for requesting reimbursement for local field office staff will be done via the Replicon application or in accordance with the field office manual. For additional details, please reference the country specific supplemental field office manual.

## 10. Personal Travel during Business Trips

If, for personal reasons, the traveler wishes to go to places other than those on the authorized Partners itinerary, he/she may book and must pay for those reservations and additional costs. The traveler should also notify the Finance Office (whether in field or at HQ) in writing that they are booking personal travel/personal portion of the trip. If the personal travel is booked on the same ticket as the Partners authorized trip, the traveler will be responsible for covering their personal travel within 30 days of the booking. If the flight cost is a cheaper ticket price including personal days on the beginning or end of the trip, the traveler does not need to reimburse any money. Travelers are only responsible for paying the difference of the ticket price. For example, travel dates for business ticket cost equals $500, travel dates including a personal portion of the trip equals $600, the staff must


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reimburse Partners the $100 difference between business ticket cost and personal portion of the trip. Appropriate documentation showing the additional costs must be kept on file for audit purposes.

## 11. Travel/Trip Reports

Travel/trip reports are needed within 30 days after the US Based/HQ and Local field office staff are back to the office from travel. The report must detail out any important results, observations, findings, and recommendations/follow-up plans, etc. The report must be submitted to the individual's supervisor for approval. Once approved, this report will be share with all staff via email. The final approved report will be filed with the expense report. The travel report template is attached in Annex C.

## 12. Partners HQ Travel Agency – Travel Leaders Corporate

Travel arrangements for approved travelers can be made through Partners HQ travel agency, Travel Leaders Corporate. Field offices can utilize a local travel agency and/or be responsible for booking their own flights, unless in coordination with HQ travel is booked under Travel Leaders Corporate. Prior to the booking of any ticket, a TA with proper authorization from supervisors must be submitted. This includes any travel outside of HQ or the respective Country Field Office, regardless of the destination and transportation mode. Prior to flight, hotel, and other bookings through Travel Leaders Corporate, the agency will require an approved TA for all travelers before the request is processed. The main contact for Travel Leaders Corporate is located below to assist with travel planning:

- Lynne Burke, Senior Client Success Specialist
  - Phone: 201-210-3851
  - Email: lburke@tlcorporate.com
- Mary Beaudoin, Client Success Specialist
  - Phone: 877-644-0333 ext. 6017014
  - Email: mbeaudoin@tlcorporate.com

Staff is also free to contact Travel Leaders Corporate's Strategic Program Manager with questions, concerns, or for assistance with complicated requests such as large groups or conference planning.

- Judy Weber, Strategic Program Manager
  - Office: 305-476-2790 (Mobile: 440-570-5902)
  - Email: jweber@tlcorporate.com

## 13. Travel Audits

All travel documents must be submitted to the Finance Office (whether in field or at HQ) with all appropriate supporting documentation in a format that can easily demonstrate to the external auditors that the policy is being followed and that the internal control system is functioning.



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### 14. Policy Oversight

This policy will be managed by the CFO of Partners of the Americas and recommendations for updates can be forwarded to the HQ Finance Office.

### 15. Travel Policy Education

All staff (both HQ & Field) and consultants (HQ based or local) are eligible for a travel policy education session with the HQ Finance Office as needed. There will be periodic refreshers sessions with all staff (HQ & Field) on an ongoing basis as necessary.

### 16. Out of Policy Safeguard

If for any reason a staff member feels that they are out of policy, then it is necessary for the staff member to secure approval from their respective supervisor. The HQ Finance Office will determine how to respond to any violation of the policy.

# Documents: E-Doc Nomenclature (Naming Convention)

### Policy

Each of Partners of the Americas (Partners) departments should follow a clear procedure that addresses the importance of establishing consistent naming practices for electronic files that are prepared for distribution within Partners and with external partners. This procedure should accomplish the following: First, ensure that those receiving the files understand what the files represent. Second, organize and keep track of the files and reference them at a future date. Third, provide a reference to the date and editor of the file (if there is one).

#### Procedure

Naming e-Documents must contain sufficient information to describe the content of the document. The key to the naming convention is to create a meaningful succinct description. Keep file names short and relevant.

1. When naming files, it is important to always include the following information:
    a. Funder / Organization name / Project (if applicable)
    b. Document content summary
    c. Date prepared or edited (year, month, day)
    d. Initials of person preparing or editing if applicable, applicable, or status of doc (e.g. Draft, final, etc.).
2. The following detail includes an example on how to properly name a proposal file.
    a. First, it is important to include the "funder / organization name / project" first (if applicable). For example, when preparing the master narrative of a Department of State (DOS) Funded proposal for Youth Ambassadors, the file could start with:
        i. DOS YA


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b. Second, the file name will also need to include the content of the document. In this case, we are naming a master narrative so the file will be named as follows:

   i. DOS YA Master Narrative or DOS YA Narrative, etc.

c. Third, the file will need to also include the date the document is prepared or modified. The date should first include the four-digit year (all four digits are used to avoid confusion with the two-digit month), followed by the two-digit month, and finally the two-digit day. Both month and day should always use two digits, even for the first 1 – 9 dates. The date should only consist of numbers and it should include hyphens (or periods) between the year, month, and day. For example:

   i. DOS YA Master Narrative 2016-02-17

   ii. Placing all of the digits is important so that when files are sorted, all similar documents will be paired together, and the files will be arranged in chronological order by year.

      1. REMEMBER: Once you receive a document with a date, if you edit the document on a later date, rename the document with the new date.

d. Lastly, if the document is edited, the initials of the editor should be included. For example, if the document was edited by Jane Doe, the file would be named as follows:

   i. DOS YA Master Narrative 2016-02-17 jd

e. If this same document is edited again on the same day by John Smith, it would be named as follows:

   i. DOS YA Master Narrative 2016-02-17 jd js

f. If, instead, the same document is edited a week later, for example on the 25th, by John Smith, it would be named as follows:

   i. DOS YA Master Narrative 2016-02-25 jd js

g. Once a final version of a document is completed, the initials may be deleted and replaced with the word "final." For example:

   i. DOS YA Master Narrative 2016-02-25 FINAL

      1. It is extremely important to do this – in particular if there are various versions and these are documents that are considered official and given to a donor or some external agency.

3. Here are some other good examples of how documents can be named:

   a. KLG Budget Draft 2014-03-01 jrm.xls (for a Kellogg budget proposal)

   b. KLG Proposal Prep Timeline 2014-03-12 mc.doc

   c. KLG Person Loading Chart Final.doc

   d. USAID F2F Award letter 2015-08.doc

   e. USAID F2F Program Description 2015-06 Final.doc

   f. SENA 100K Cover Page Cost Proposal 2017.doc



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g. SENA 100K Attach5 List of Contacts 2017.doc

Contracts:

h. 100K WU FixCost 2019-05-01 to 07-30 CoverSheet

i. 92RD Mcardenas IC 2018-01-01 to 2019-01-31FullyExecuted

# Staff & Employment

Please see the Employee Manual for official policies regarding employment, leave, holidays, benefits, and other Human Resources issues.

## Communicating Absences

All time out of the office must be marked on the Staff Calendar folder in Outlook with as much advance notice as possible. Staff members may email all staff about their travel plans if there is the possibility their time there might benefit other programs or units. However, emails to all staff about other absences are usually not necessary and should be kept to a minimum.

### Updating voicemail

When staff are out of the office for more than a day, it is recommended that they set up their outgoing voicemail message so that people are informed that they are out of the office and when are they coming back, and possibly who will be covering for them during that time. In the "greetings" menu of your voicemail you have the option to record and switch to an "alternate" out-of-office message, then you can easily switch back when you return to the office.

### Automatic reply

When staff are out of the office for more than a day, it is recommended that they set up an "automatic reply" on their email so that people are informed that they are out of the office, when are they coming back and who they should contact in case of an urgent issue. This can be configured in Outlook under the "File Menu" in the "Automatic Replies (Out of Office)" section.

### Staff calendar

Whenever a staff member will be out of the office, it must be indicated on the Staff Calendar in Outlook along with information regarding times/dates and the reason for being out of the office (such as trip details, AL – Annual Leave, SL – Sick Leave, WFH – Work From Home, etc.). Details beyond that are not necessary for personal leave. However, additional information is required when the absence is due to business-related meetings, activities or trips.

When indicating that you'll be out of the office for travel, write the complete name of the event you're attending in the *subject* header. Use the *body* of the calendar note to provide additional information (even if only preliminary) on your activities or needs that could be helpful to either Program Development or Communications. For example:

- *Subject*: "Michelle in Guatemala for II Summit of Indigenous Journalists"

  *Body*: "Meeting with Shakira's people—what materials do I need to have on hand?"



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If you are traveling to multiple locations, please note the change of location on the staff calendar, as well as if you are attending additional events using the same procedure as above.

Please indicate all possible travel on the Staff Calendar as early as possible. The Communications Unit maintains an editorial calendar that runs three to six months out, and in some cases more, so to guarantee that your needs can be covered we need to know about travel requiring communications support as early as possible

If you are planning a Partners event, please indicate the dates of the event on the Staff Calendar as early as possible. If your program participants are traveling/organizing their own events and you require communications support, please also indicate on Staff Calendar. For example:

- *Subject*: "Maria Gomez- CC Fellow- To International Water Conference Asuncion, PY"

  *Body*: "Maria needs a press release prior to the event. She also wants to speak to press in Asuncion about water rights."

Even if you are only out of the office in Washington, DC to attend an event, please indicate using the same procedures as above.

### Late arrivals

Please be sure to alert your supervisor if you will be arriving more than 30 minutes late. Late arrivals generally do not need to be communicated to all staff.

## Hiring of New Staff and/or Consultants

### Staff

Information regarding the hiring process and other applicable documents can be found here.

### Consultants

Consultants (including interns) are hired based on specific scopes of work that are to be prepared by their supervisor. All contracts need to include:

- Scope of work
- Terms of payment and compensation rate
- Performance period
- Name of supervisor

The Finance Office has templates available for consultant contracts here and intern contracts here. Once a contract has been prepared, it must be presented to the Contracts Department for approval prior to being signed by the consultant or intern, please follow the contracts policy.

Consultants and interns do not accrue benefits and they are responsible for their own taxes regardless of citizenship. Partners provides the form 1099 at the end of the year for US-based payees. Consultants and interns are paid upon presentation of all reports, products and deliverables stated on their agreements. All travel expenses are verified and



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supported by backups and follow all staff travel policies. To issue a payment to a consultant or intern, a check, ACH or wire transfer request is to be prepared with all documentation listed above, and signed by a supervisor.

## New Staff Orientation

All staff receive a new staff orientation during their first days at Partners. It is the responsibility of the supervisor, in coordination with the Human Resource (HR) Office, to ensure that the new staff member is adequately briefed by other staff.

The purpose of the orientation is first, to brief new employees on our activities and responsibilities so they can become as comfortable and productive as possible, as rapidly as possible; and second, to build from the start the sort of lateral communication across our organization that creates a healthy work environment and makes the whole greater than the sum of the parts.

The orientation has several elements.

- Official processing of employee (payroll, benefits, etc.) by the HR Office and an overview of employee manual, policies and procedures
- Detailed introduction by the supervisor, focused on the job and its relationship to the organization
- Meetings between the new employee and the President
- Meeting with each Program or Unit Director to be informed about each program's mission, procedures, and possible relationships to the new employee's work
- Meeting with the Finance & Administration Office to explain policies and procedures pertinent to the new staff member's grant or unit, budget, etc.
- Employee initiative, to fill in holes and specific needs

For more information regarding the orientation and on-boarding process contact the HR Office. On-boarding, copies of policies and other HR forms and resources can also be found here.

## Staff Development

Partners encourages employees to attend presentations, workshops, or discussions on topics related to their professional interests as much as possible. Staying professionally current is a high priority. Financial support for training, conferences, coursework, and other forms of capacity-building that require a paid fee and/or time off from work, will be considered on an individual basis, guided by the following three categories:

1. Skills that are integrally involved in the most important responsibilities of the employee's position.
2. Skills that are involved in some aspects of the employee's position, but are not wholly and/or directly related to the most important.
3. Training, important for general development, but with no direct involvement in the employee's position.

Approval for training in Category 1 may provide for full reimbursement, training in Category 2 may provide for half and in Category 3 by discretion.



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Reimbursement in all three categories is conditional upon available program and administrative resources. When possible, training for Categories 1 and 2 should be paid for by individual programs. When not possible, such training should draw on the Partners Professional Development administrative budget (if available). Category 3 will most likely depend on the Professional Development budget. Reimbursement in any category should be recommended by the relevant supervisor or grant manager, and approved by the CFO or the President.

### Performance Evaluation

Good evaluations are multi-dimensional. Employees should have a self-evaluation in mind, and complete a form themselves. Good evaluations also include supervisor consultations with others who know the employee's work, including people in other offices or even outside Partners. This "360 degree" evaluation depends upon both the supervisor's initiative in seeking additional feedback, and proactive efforts of staff to provide such feedback to appropriate supervisors. The process should include all staff, from the President to every member at HQ and field offices.

The supervisor does the evaluation taking these various inputs into account to supplement his or her own perceptions. The supervisor should also seek feedback from the person being evaluated. Once the process is completed, an overall performance level is given, and the form is signed by the employee and the supervisor. The supervisor submits these to the respective Vice President or directly to President, when applicable and a copy to the HR Office.

For official policies regarding performance reviews and salary increases, please consult the Employee Manual or contact the HR Office.

## Financial

### Grant Numbers and Line Items

Partners' assigns grant numbers to all programs depending on the type of activity. These are generally designated as follows, with some exceptions.

- 90s – Administration
- 100s – Civil Society
- 200s – Education and Culture (Exchanges)
- 300s – Training
- 400s – Social and Economic Development
- 500s – Health
- 600s – Agriculture and Environment

### Check Requests

Check requests are used for payments via check issued from the Finance Office. A copy of this form can be found here. Please include all necessary back up documentation when requesting a check.



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- Write the "Payable To" name of the person or organization as you would like it to appear on the check.
- If the address you are providing is new or different than the last time a check was requested for this vendor, please bring it to our attention so the adjustment can be made in our system prior to printing the check.
- The coding section should be completed with assistance from your supervisor, as it directly affects the program or grant's budget. A list of possible Activities and Line Items can be found on your grants or units' budget. If you need a copy please find copies of all budget here.
- Include a Customer Reference or Account Number, Invoice Number and Invoice Date if applicable.
- Whatever you write in the "Check Memo" section will appear on the check, and also as a description in our system and on reports. Because that is limited to a certain number of characters, you can provide more detailed information for the files in the space below.
- Person requesting and supervisor approval are necessary for payment.
- Checks over $25,000 require two authorized signatories to be in the office.

Completed requests should be left in the appropriate bin in the Finance Office or saved in the electronic folder here. Check requests are processed in accordance with the Payment Calendar.

## ACH Requests

ACH requests are used for payments issued electronically from the Finance Office to bank accounts in the US. A copy of this form can be found here. Please include all necessary back up documentation when requesting the ACH payment.

- Write the "Payable To" name of the person or organization who will be paid, note this should also match the contract, invoice, etc.
- Please provide a copy of the ACH Bank Information form, or complete the ABA routing number and account number on the cover sheet.
- The coding section should be completed with assistance from your supervisor, as it directly affects the program or grant's budget. A list of possible Activities and Line Items can be found on your grants or units' budget. If you need a copy please find copies of all budget here.
- Include a Customer Reference or Account Number, Invoice Number and Invoice Date if applicable.
- Whatever you write in the "ACH Memo" section will appear on the ACH transfer note, and also as a description in our system and on reports. Because that is limited to a certain number of characters, you can provide more detailed information for the files in the space below.
- Person requesting and supervisor approval are necessary for payment.
- Please let the Finance Office know who should be alerted once payment is complete. Once confirmations are sent, the staff member who submitted the request is responsible for passing along the payment confirmations to the payee.

Completed requests should be left in the appropriate bin in the Finance Office or saved in the electronic folder here. ACH requests are processed in accordance with the Payment Calendar.



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## Wire Transfer Requests

Wire transfers can be requested for international transactions. A copy of this form can be found here. Please include all necessary back up documentation with your request.

The form allows you to provide the basic bank information necessary for most wires, but when sending a wire transfer to a new payee it is better for the payee to request instructions from their bank. Every country and sometimes banks have different requirements, and wires sent with bad information are not always returned to Partners.

- Write the "Payable To" name of the person or organization as it appears on their bank account, note this should also match the contract, invoice, etc.
- International Banks at a minimum require the SWIFT code (all letters) and the account number. Many countries require more information, which is why it is best to have the payee ask their bank for instructions. Almost all international wires will have fees deducted by the recipient's bank, but the amounts can vary widely, so they should ask their bank before the payment is made. To collect this bank information, please have vendors complete a wire transfer bank information form.
- If Partners has sent a wire to a particular payee before, we may have saved their information for future wires. It is important to bring it to our attention if any bank information has changed from a previous request.
- The coding section should be completed with assistance from your supervisor, as it directly affects the program or grant's budget. A list of possible Activities and Line Items can be found on your grants or units' budget. If you need a copy please find copies of all budget here.
- Include an Invoice Number and Invoice Date if applicable.
- Whatever you write in the "Memo" section will be included when the wire transfer is processed, and also as a description in our system and on reports. Because that is limited to a certain number of characters, you can provide more detailed information for the files in the space below.
- Please let the Finance Office know who should be alerted once payment is complete. Once confirmations are sent, the staff member who submitted the request is responsible for passing along the payment confirmations to the payee.
- Person requesting and supervisor approval are necessary for payment.

Completed requests should be left in the appropriate bin in the Finance Office or saved in the electronic folder here. Wire requests are processed in accordance with the Payment Calendar.

## PayPal or Western Union Requests

Partners aims to process all payments via wire, ACH or check, however, in some situations Partners recognizes that payments may need to be sent via PayPal or Western Union. Both of these options should only be used if necessary, as these services charge high fees and consume more time to process. To process a Western Union payment the payment request form can be found here. Please note that Western Union payments may only be sent to individuals and is not available for organizations. To process a PayPal payment the payment request form can be found here. Please include all necessary back up documentation with your request.



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- Write the "Payable To" name of the person or organization, note this should also match the contract, invoice, etc.
- Note, for Western Union payments a copy of the individuals identification card will be required. This ID should be the same that the individual plans to use to collect the funds once sent.
- Note, for PayPal payments, vendors should email an invoice to the point of contact (POC) at Partners HQ. The POC will then forward the invoice link to the finance department for payment processing.
- The coding section should be completed with assistance from your supervisor, as it directly affects the program or grant's budget. A list of possible Activities and Line Items can be found on your grants or units' budget. If you need a copy please find copies of all budget here.
- Include an Invoice Number and Invoice Date if applicable.
- Whatever you write in the "Memo" section will be included as a description in our system and on reports. Because that is limited to a certain number of characters, you can provide more detailed information for the files in the space below.
- Please let the Finance Office know who should be alerted once payment is complete. Once confirmations are sent, the staff member who submitted the request is responsible for passing along the payment confirmations to the payee.
- Person requesting and supervisor approval are necessary for payment.

Completed requests should be left in the appropriate bin in the Finance Office or saved in the electronic folder here. PayPal requests are processed in accordance with the Payment Calendar. Western Union requests are processed after the payment dates in the Payment Calendar, for exact dates, please contact the Finance Office.

## American Express, VISA and Corporate Cards

Staff that travel frequently may have American Express and/or VISA cards issued in their names. The use of the cards is for business use only and all expenses must be reconciled monthly and submitted to the Finance & Administration Office by the due date indicated on the statement, which is usually 14 days after the statement is received.

Partners benefits from the use of corporate cards by accumulating points and rebates. For information about redeeming rewards or miles, speak with the Finance & Administration Office.

## Procurement Policies and Procedures

Partners of the Americas acquires goods and services through various funds, including core and grant and contract funds. It is the policy of Partners to follow the requirements of Procurement Standards 2CFR200and 22CFR226 and the OMB Circular 110 regarding the procurement of goods and services especially for U.S. government-funded projects. The nature of grants with the U.S. government and most other donors means that all costs incurred may eventually be audited by public accountants or the Inspector General's office. It is therefore essential to negotiate the most economical conditions for purchases. Procurement will be made with complete impartiality based strictly on the merits of a supplier's proposal and applicable related considerations such as delivery, quantity, after-sale service, etc.

The Finance & Administration Office is responsible for reviewing all bids and must ensure funds are available for purchases. All bids and purchase documents must be saved in the Finance Office for future audits. It is the policy of


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Partners of the Americas to procure only those items which are required to fulfill the objectives of grants and contracts, or those which are genuinely needed by the organization to meet its mission.

Please reference our Procurement Policy for complete details.

### Petty Cash

The Finance & Administration Office manages a small petty cash fund which is used to reimburse or advance for expenses under $25. Receipts and a Petty Cash slip are required.

## Communications

All information covered below is for general reference only. For detailed information on Partners' branding guidelines and communications policies, please contact the Communications Department.

### Partners Logos

Part of raising the visibility of Partners (which is directly linked to funding) is providing a consistent, high quality look. In keeping with this objective, branding experts recommend that we present our logo in a consistent fashion – this helps "brand" Partners in people's minds.

The Partners' Logo and other logos can be found here. There are a few different logos for different situations, please consult with the Communications unit before including any logos in your publications or external communications. Here are some rules of thumb to keep in mind when using the logo:

- Should be displayed prominently (so that it is not hard to find) on all publications
- Should remain consistent – keep the mark consistent with the logotype

### External Communication & Publications

Major external communication and printed publications must be reviewed by the Communications team before dissemination. The team will review for clarity of message and design considerations related to placement of logo and recognition of donors/sponsors. This will be done as expeditiously as possible, however please plan for a couple of revisions in your production process. It is also recommended to consult first with the Communications team to get some input up-front. Partners has Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, and LinkedIn accounts. If teams would like to feature their programs and content on social media, contact the Communications team for consultation and approval.

#### News releases

All programs are encouraged to periodically communicate their achievements and news (i.e. when launching a program, when significant achievements or events take place, final results, etc.). The Communications team is available to provide guidelines and suggestions. Program budgets should cover translation and printing costs whenever possible.



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### Stored publications

Partners stores and displays a variety of publications in communication closet. These include Partners' annual report, maps, folders, one-pagers, and event information. Any restrictions on the use of these items will be noted in the area they are stored in.

### Web

Partners' website is http://www.partners.net. Take a look at the site and familiarize yourself with its contents. All teams and programs are responsible for maintaining current information on their programs in all relevant languages in consultation with the Communications team.

### Business Cards

Please contact the Communications team to order or replenish Business Cards.

### Bio

All new employees must submit their photo and a bio to the Communications team. The supervisor should guide them on this task.

### Pins

Partners has pins that are orange with the Partners logo. The price varies; they are usually sold at cost to volunteers and members. Please see the Communications Unit regarding payment for pins. Programs may have their own promotional merchandise more specific to their grant, which is produced in coordination with the Communications team.

## Office & Equipment

### Phones

The main phone number for Partners is (202) 628-3300 or Toll-Free (800) 322-7844.

Most staff direct lines are 202-637-6XXX, the last three digits being the person's extension (some intern extensions do not have a direct dial number). We did run out of 202-637-6XXX phone numbers so now all new phone numbers are (202)524-6XXX. The phone display will say which extension it is currently programmed for and the name associated with that extension.

Our phones use a Voice over IP (VoIP) system. There is an accompanying online portal called Office Suite. You can access our Office Suite portal by going to this web address: https://officesuite2.broadviewnet.net/webadmin/login/202633AAAB

Quick start guides with a lot of useful information regarding the phones, online portal and voicemail system can be found here. Many phone settings can be configured through the Office Suite portal such as call forwarding, call coverage, memory keys, etc.



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## Logging in / out of phones

To "log into" a phone, press the button (soft key) next to "ACTIVATE" on the phone's screen. Enter your extension number and pin, and press the "ENTER" soft key. To "log out" of a phone, press the following soft keys: "MENU" "LOGOUT" >"YES".

## Outgoing calls

To make a call, lift the handset or press the key for the speakerphone.

- To call an internal extension, simply dial the 3-digit number.
- For domestic calls, dial **9 + 1 + Area Code + Phone Number** (even for 202 numbers).
- To call internationally, dial **9 + 011 + Country Code + Phone Number**. You have been assigned an international calling code which you will need to enter upon placing the call. Contact the Administration Officer if you need to request an international calling code.

## Incoming calls

When you receive a call, it will say under the caller ID information "For: ___" to indicate if the call is to your direct line, your department group, the main line, etc. To change the ring tones for different types of calls, log into Office Suite go to "My Phone" → "Configure Ring Tones."

## Main line

All interns, program and unit officers share the responsibility of answering the main line and lobby intercom line, and then assisting or directing callers. The main line and intercom line do not ring on everyone's phone, only those responsible for answering it.

## Transferring calls

To transfer, while on a call, press the "Transfer/Confere" soft key or the button on the phone. Then enter the person's or group's 3-digit extension. The call will transfer when you hang up the receiver, so you can stay on the line and let the person know who is calling or simply hang up after you dial the extension.

## Unlocking the elevator

Guests/Visitors using the intercom located outside of your main doors will appear as "**Douglas Dev**" on the phone. **To unlock the main doors, press " 9 " on the phone keypad while on the intercom call.**

Be sure to ask who they are coming to visit at Partners before granting access. Also, let them know that they will have access to the elevator upon entering and to go directly to the 7th or 4th Floor.

## Conference calls

Conference or three-way calls can be initiated once you are already on a call. Ask the current caller to hold, then press the "Transfer/Confere" soft key or the button on the phone. Dial 91 / 9011 + the number for the second caller. Once the second call is answered, press the "Transfer/Confere" key or button again to join the calls.



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For conference calls requiring a larger number of participants, staff should utilize their InterCall Reservationless Plus account. Each employee was assigned a username upon employment. If you are in need of a user account, please contact the Administration Officer.

### Voicemail

To access your voicemail, press the button on your phone. Unless you are otherwise instructed, the default pin number is 1234. When you set up your mailbox for the first time it will prompt you to change it to something more personal.

Your voicemail greeting should say something along these lines: "*Hello – this is (name) (title or department) at Partners of the Americas. I'm either on the phone or away from my desk. Please leave your message at the sound of the tone and I'll return your call as soon as possible. If you need immediate assistance, press zero for an operator*."

### Offsite voicemail access

When you're out of the office and you want to hear your messages by phone, call the main line 202-628-3300. Once the greeting begins, press * and the voice prompts will walk you through the steps. To access your voicemail online, visit https://voicemail.broadviewnet.com/Default.aspx?UserName. In the "Telephone Number" field enter our main number (2026283300), and then enter your extension and password (voicemail pin number).

There is also a Broadview Office Suite voicemail app available for iPhone and Android (search "Office Suite Voicemail" in the app store).

## Office Supplies Purchases

Partners can purchase office supplies as need from lost cost providers. Partners has corporate discount accounts with Staples Advantage and Amazon. You may request orders at your convenience; however, all orders must be approved by the Executive Administrative Office.

## Printers & Copiers

Partners has the following printers and copiers available:

- Ricoh 2352-4th Floor - B&W, Color, Copy, and Scan
- Ricoh C6501- 7th Floor – B&W, Color, Copy, Fax and Scan

Please contact FSI Strategies at 202-730-9701 to set up the laser printer closest to your desk.

For supplies or repair requests please contact Executive Administrative Department. An order will then be placed to order supplies or put in a repair request.

### Printer settings

Because Partners has supply and maintenance agreements with Centric/Ricoh, we pay on a per-page basis. Additional costs for color are charged based on the amount of color used on the page. We recommend using the "Green" settings as your default printer settings, which is B&W and 2-sided printing. You can always override these settings before an individual print job if needed.



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### Sending faxes

To send a fax from the 7th floor RicohC6501 machine, select the "Fax" option on the home screen and type in the recipient's number before placing the documents in the scanning tray. Press the "Start" button to scan and fax the document.

### Scanning

Both Ricoh copiers have the scanning functionality. On either machine, select the "Email" option on the home screen. Either search for your name in the address book or type your email address in the "To:" field. Set your scanning options, then press the "Start" button. A .pdf of your scan will be sent to the email addressed indicated.

## Computer Support

FSI Strategies is our computer/network support company and provides assistance through remote support (with on-site support when necessary). Contact information and ID number for your machine can be found on the sticker on your monitor or CPU.

Please see the following Guide information:



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FSi Strategies

www.fsistrategies.com

# Welcome Guide

## FSI Strategies Managed Services

We appreciate the trust and confidence you have placed in us and we look forward to working for you. At FSI Strategies, we strive to provide you with the highest level of service in the industry. With FSI Strategies, our goal is to bring consistency, reliability, performance, and security to your technology. Our priority is to maintain your network in peak working condition and to be there when you call us for help and guidance.

**Service Desk Information**
Phone: 202-730-9701
support@fsistrategies.com

**Regular** Business Hours
8a – 6p (Monday – Friday)

**Non-Business Hours** (Weekends & Holidays)
8a – 6p (Saturday, Sunday, & Holidays)
6p – 8a (Saturday, Sunday, & Holidays)

**Emergency Contact** (what to do during non-business hours)
Email or contact the main Service Desk number & leave a voicemail. Your voicemail will be transcribed & sent to the "on-call" Network Administrator.

## HOW WE WORK FOR YOU

We have assembled the best team of certified technicians and engineers to work for you. Our staff is trained to manage and support your entire IT network - they work daily to ensure that your questions are answered and that your systems are protected and running at peak performance.

### Unlimited On-Demand Site Visits

- Technician will be on site to assist in person in the event an issue cannot be resolved remotely
- Allows for quicker resolution with a "hands-on" approach

### Proactive Maintenance

- Daily proactive maintenance of your servers, desktops, & network devices
- Daily data backup & network security tasks
- Fully leverage Systems Automation and Industry Best-Practices

### Service Desk Staff

- Leverage remote technology to answer your "how-to" questions
- Acknowledge & resolve problems you report (i.e., **incidents**)
- Escalate incidents to the assigned Network Administrator when resolution requires more in-depth skills

## OUR GOALS

- Our mission is to deliver a "High-Value" service while playing a strategic role for your organization.
- This mission allows us to offer a different value to our clients: a completely different mindset & culture versus the traditional support & maintenance of your IT environment
- With your proactive & comprehensive service, we ensure that your technical capabilities are always driven by your real business needs.



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FSi Strategies

## PRIORITY LEVELS (definitions)

### Priority Levels

Service Requests made by the Client will be classified as Priority Levels 1, 2, 3, or 4 as defined in this Attachment. Response and Resolution Times will be managed according to the priority level of a service request.

### Response Time

Response Time is the time it takes for the Company to acknowledge, in a non-automated way, a service request submitted by the Client to the Company's Service Desk. During the Response Time, the Company will contact the Client either by phone or email to confirm that the service request has been received and to provide information regarding resolution. Furthermore, the Company will create a Service Ticket for each service request.

### Resolution Time

Resolution Time is the time it takes for the Company to successfully remediate the Client's issue or successfully answer their question. It is measured from the time a Service Ticket is created until the time that the Client is advised that their service request has been resolved. Problems associated with services provided by third- party vendors as well as problems due to hardware and/or software failure are exempt from the Resolution Times listed in this Attachment.

**Users Affected**

| | All | Majority | Limited | Single |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| No Workaround | Priority Level 1 | Priority Level 2 | Priority Level 3 | Priority Level 4 |
| Workaround | Priority Level 2 | Priority Level 3 | Priority Level 4 | Priority Level 4 |

**Response & Resolution Times:**
Monday – Friday (Business Hours, 8a – 6p)

| | Priority Level 1 | Priority Level 2 | Priority Level 3 | Priority Level 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Response | 15 mins | 30 mins | 45 mins | 45 mins |
| Resolution | 4 business hrs | 8 business hrs | 24 business hrs | 40 business hrs |

**Response & Resolution Times:**
Weekends & Holidays (Non-Business Hours, 8a – 6p)

| | Priority Level 1 | Priority Level 2 | Priority Level 3 | Priority Level 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Response | 45 mins | 1 hr | n/a | n/a |
| Resolution | 6 hrs | 8 hrs | n/a | n/a |

**Response & Resolution Times:**
Weekends & Holidays (Non-Business Hours, 6p – 8a)

| | Priority Level 1 | Priority Level 2 | Priority Level 3 | Priority Level 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | best efforts | best efforts | n/a | n/a |
| Resolution | best efforts | best efforts | n/a | n/a |



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### New users

New Partners user accounts and emails for intern or staff members must be requested by the supervisor's email FSI directly with these requests. Requests must be emailed to support@fsistratgies.com at least 72 hours advance notice. You will need to send them the full name of the staff member and let them know the computer ID number where they will most likely sit (if you know that information). If the user needs special access, permissions, or if they should be in any particular email groups, please include that in your request.

### Guest user

Visitors to our office or anyone who does not have a designated username can log onto a workstation using the "Guest" log-in:

- Username: poa.guest@partners.net
- Password: [password is changed regularly; you can request the most recent password from IT]

### Wireless internet

The Partners office has two Wi-Fi hubs:

- Staff SSID: POA (For Staff Only)
- Password: POA@1424kstreet

- Guest SSID: POA-Guest (Guest for Guest Only)
- Password: #POAWelcome#

### Shared address book(s) and distribution lists

There are several address books or distribution lists available to Partners staff through Outlook. The Global Address list includes all general addresses including staff, board of directors and partnerships. Updates to these lists should be emailed to FSI Strategies at support@fsistrategies.com and copy rtorres@partners.net.

An email can be distributed to the Partners staff that work in the DC Office by addressing an email to DCStaff@Partners.net. To email the entire Partners staff, including international affiliate organizations, an email can be addressed to AllStaff@Partners.net.

### Read-Only Folder

Please note all staff have access to a lot of useful documents in the READ ONLY folder, such as current and past staff contact information, field office information, etc.

The Partners Directory is also located here, and is continuously updated by Carmen Sepassi. As we are informed of changes in the chapters officers' mailing address, telephone and fax numbers, and e-mail address if any, they are updated and saved in the folder for easy accessibility. Please let Carmen Sepassi at csepassi@partners.net know if you have any corrections, additions, changes, etc. to any of these documents.



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### Database

Partners has a database that stores information regarding volunteers, travel, partnerships, donors, organizations, programs and projects. It is an important tool for Partners and one we hope you will utilize frequently. Contact IT support for assistance setting up and accessing the database on your computer.

## Security

New employees and interns should see the Executive Administration Office to be assigned a building security key fob. The building security key fob is necessary 24 hours a day to access our suites and enter the building at all times. In case of loss the employee will be responsible for covering the cost of its replacement (currently $20).

### Elevators

Visitors and deliveries must request access via the intercom located outside of the building's main doors. To unlock the main doors, dial "9" on your keypad while on the intercom line. Be sure to meet the visitor or delivery at the elevator, or make sure the appropriate person is going to meet them. This system helps us keep our floor secure since there are limited concierge services in the lobby. Don't be afraid to ask who they are, whom they are here to visit or whom their package is for.

### Alarm

Our security alarm system is provided and monitored by Kastle Security Systems. The main security alarm is located in Suite 700 and the reader is adjacent to the reception desk. The alarm will automatically arm and disarm- It will be armed Monday to Friday from 8pm to 8am, and disarmed from 8:01am to 7:59 pm Monday to Friday. The security alarm will be armed all day Saturday & Sunday. In addition, Partners Suites located on the 4th Floor have a key reader located outside of the main door entry. Although these readers do not have a sensor tied to a siren, the activity is still monitored by Kastle. Furthermore, only Partners staff has the ability to arm and disarm the security alarm by swiping their key fob on the reader during nonbusiness hours. If the alarm is tripped Kastle will follow the set protocol- Kastle will notify the primary contact (Renata Torres) with a phone call and a follow up email to inquire how to proceed. Kastle will follow the instructions given by the Primary Contact. Should the Primary Contact not be available, Kastle will then contact the secondary and tertiary point of contacts (Executive Administrative Office). Directors have been given 2 extra key fobs so that at their discretion, they may assign it to their intern or consultant. The Director will be responsible for managing the two extra key fobs. For example, the Director will make sure to give and receive the key fob back from the intern or consultant upon start and ending of employment. Additional keys will not be given; each program may decide to purchase additional key fobs ($20 each) if needed. If Directors are informed that either of their extra key fobs is misplaced, lost, or stolen- the Finance & Administration Office will need to be notified immediately. At which time, a replacement key fob will be ordered and the cost of $20 each will be charged to the program/dept. Please make an important note of the following- key fobs assigned to interns and consultants will have restricted access. They will only have access to our suites during business hours from 8am to 5:30 pm Monday to Friday - no weekend access, no exceptions.

Finally, to arm or disarm follow these steps:

To Arm- Swipe your key fob on the reader pad located adjacent to the reception desk. The light will go from green to red. You will have 30 seconds to clear the room. To Disarm- Swipe your key fob on the reader pad located adjacent to the reception desk. The light will go from red to green.



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### Safety

The health and safety of our Partners family is always our top priority, and everyone can play a part in making the Partners office a comfortable, secure environment. Before our elevators required a key fob to access our suites, we had a few instances of petty theft of personal possessions from employees' offices. There have also been reports of unauthorized persons in the lobby or building after hours, often getting past locked doors and elevators by coercing the cleaning crew or waiting for people to leave which gives them momentary access. While there have never been any major threats to the safety of our staff or office, we believe that vigilance and prevention are the best way to avoid possible dangers.

- If you feel uncomfortable for any reason, don't feel pressured to let someone onto the floor until you have verified that they have a legitimate reason for requesting access.
- When visitors call on the intercom, find out who they are there to meet and alert that person to greet them at the elevator or lobby. If the person they are meeting isn't available to greet them, meet them at the elevators or lobby yourself and accompany them to that person.
- For deliveries, even if it's not for you, go to the elevator to sign for or receive the package. Don't assume the staff near the elevators will always do this.
- If you encounter someone in the lobby, call or find the person they are meeting to confirm the meeting and let that person grant them access. Don't be afraid to say that you they can't ride up with you until that person gives permission.
- If they can't immediately name who they are meeting or why they want access, then it is a good clue that something might be wrong – especially after hours. Once an unauthorized man on the floor, when confronted about his reason for being there, said he was meeting the person on the first nameplate he saw (when in reality that person had left the office for the day).
- If someone is seeking access to another floor, don't get involved. The callbox in front of the building is a good place to direct visitors trying to access other floors.
- If you are working late in the office, check to see if others are here as well. Don't stay in the office late at night or leave by yourself. There is safety and comfort in numbers.
- If you feel unsure, don't get in the elevator or otherwise involve yourself in a situation with someone you don't know. If you find yourself in an uncomfortable situation, try to get away from it and when you are safe, call for help.

Remember that your safety and security should always be the first concern, and it is more important than any item we possess in our office.

## Conference Room

Partners has the Kennedy Conference room available for meetings. The large conference room located on the 7th Floor and seats approximately 30-40 people, depending on configuration. The room should be reserved in advance for meeting by signing up through the "Conference Rooms" shared calendar in the Public Folders in Outlook. Anyone is free to use this room at any time but meetings with reservations always have preference. If you want to reserve and use the video conference system in the LCR, you need to add Mainconfereceroom@partnerns.net to the calendar invitation. you will receive an email of accepted or declined request according to the room availability.



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Staff members with larger offices should leave their offices neat and accessible while out of the office, so that they can be used by other staff for smaller, informal meetings.

## Kitchen Duty

As we all use the kitchen at some point, we are all responsible for keeping it clean and organized. All staff will be assigned a week for kitchen duty, which you can trade with another staff member if you will be out of the office. Kitchen duty includes:

- Running the dishwasher at night
- Unloading the dishwasher in the morning
- Generally making sure the kitchen is clean and in order

Everyone is responsible for putting their dirty dishes in dishwasher and cleaning up their own mess on the counter, in the microwave, etc. as well as keeping the refrigerator clean and preventing overcrowding/spoiled food.

## Green Initiatives

Partners is always looking for ways to make our office and work more environmentally conscious. Here are some of our current "Green" initiatives, and we are always open to suggestions of new ways we can reduce our environmental impact.

### Email signature

Partners requires all staff to have a uniformed email signature. The email signature template can be found here. Please download the document, then copy it into the email signature template and update according to ensure the same formatting.

Encourage others to be more thoughtful about their printer usage by adding a line to your signature like this: Please consider the environment before printing this email.

Here is a website that can help walk you through the steps: http://www.ehow.com/how_5420224_insert-environmental-message-outlook-signature.html

### Lights

Remember to turn off the lights in your office (if separate from the main lights) before you leave at night. If you are one of the last to leave to the office, help make sure the bathroom, conference room and kitchen lights are turned off. The last person to leave should turn off the main lights at the switch by the elevators before setting the alarm.

### Recycle

DC law requires businesses to recycle, and around the office are different bins for trash, paper and other recyclables. Please be conscious of where you toss things, since we or the landlord could be fined if our refuse is not sorted correctly. Therefore, it's also a good idea to mark the bin(s) in your office using one of the three categories (trash, paper, or recyclables), so the cleaning company has no doubts about what to do with the contents.

There is a shredder near the copier machines so you can shred documents with sensitive information before recycling. There is a 10-15-page limit that can be shredded at a time.



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### Reuse

Keep a bin or folder in your office to save scrap paper for expense reports (to attach receipts), notes, drafts, calculations, etc. Before throwing away a binder, folder, etc. that you no longer need, please remove the papers to be recycled/reused, and place the supplies back in the kitchen for someone else to us.

### Set your printing defaults

Please contact FSI Strategies to help set up your printer defaults. See the section in "Printers & Copiers" for their contact information.

# Contracts

## Templates

Approved Contract templates can be found here.

Templates are available for the following:

- Cover Sheet Templates
- Standard Annexes (Annex B-E)
- Standard Provisions (Annex F POA standard provision and Annex G USG mandatory provisions)
- 100K Templates
- Close Out Letter Templates
- Consulting Templates (Independent consulting Agreement's template, Modification's template)
- Donor Closeout Letter Templates
- Honorarium Agreement Template
- Interns & Volunteer Templates
- Mini Sub Agreement Templates
- MOU Templates
- Proposal Position Teaming Agreement Templates
- Small Grant Agreement (Subaward) Templates
- Small Grant Winner Agreement Template
- Sub Agreement Templates
- Subcontract Templates
- Teaming Agreements

Going forward, please use these approved templates for handling contracts. Additionally, you will find that some of the templates are offered in Spanish as well.

There will be cases in which may require you to use a customized template, which is fine, but please remember that we'd like to lean as much as possible to standardizing our contracts so that they can be more manageable.

Important: Please ensure the template you are going to work with is saved in your files prior to using them. We'd like to ensure that they are not accidentally overwritten.



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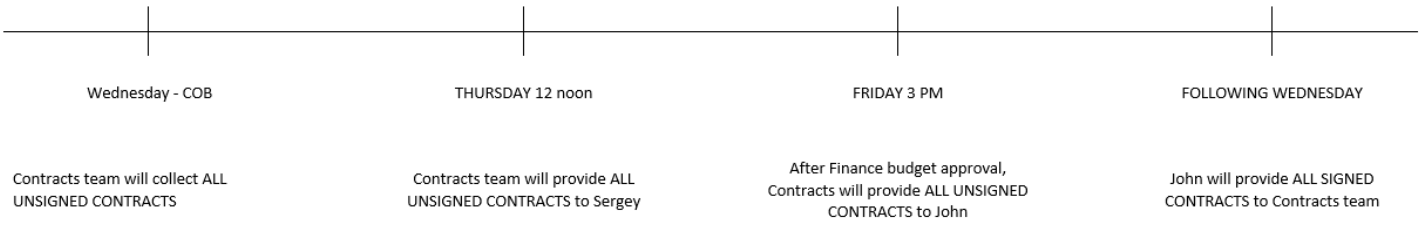
## Process

All staff should send contracts and agreements to Contracts@partners.net. Pleases see and follow the following timeline process, also note that there are some agreements that doesn't need the President's approval (for more information see the Contracts Policy & Procedures below).

### CONTRACT TIMELINE




Before you send the documents to the Contracts email, have in mind the following documents you need to submit:

## Contracts Check List

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | 1 | Is the cover sheet approved by the program/unit director? |
| | 2 | Is the Contract saved? |
| | 3 | Check for procurement (If total award including any modifications are $10K+). |
| | 4 | Check for risk assessment (if total award including any modifications are $100K+). |
| | 5 | Visual Compliance screening ran and saved |
| | 6 | Detail Budget (if need it) |

## Policy & Procedure, Authorized Agreement Signatory Approvers

### Purpose

The purpose of this policy/procedure is to streamline the approval process for contracts, agreements, letters of understanding, MOUs, etc. (hereinafter referred to as AGREEMENTS), by providing definitions of types of AGREEMENTS for approvals and the signatory level(s) required.

### Effective Date

This policy/procedure is effective on February 20, 2019.



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### Policy: Signatory Approvers

Members of the President's Council (Program Department Directors) are authorized to sign the types of AGREEMENTS defined in Section 4 and under the scenarios in Section 5, with the exception of the CFO, whose role is to provide the monitoring and approval of the use of funds for the AGREEMENTS.

### Types of AGREEMENTS requiring approval

This document defines the approval process for the following types of AGREEMENTS:

- Contracts with independent consultants
- Contracts or agreements with organizations, governments, corporations, foundations
- Letters of Understanding, MOUs and Teaming agreements for proposals

Note that this does not include AGREEMENTS for individuals who will work out of our office as part of their contract, such as interns, volunteers, full or part-time staff and contractors.

### Approved Scenarios

Important notes:

- All of the below scenarios assume that there is an established and transparent selection processes; and
- Any change in monetary value is already within current fiscal year budgets approved by the President & CEO; and
- Any total value or change in monetary value is less than or equal to $25,000 of program funds;
- Any AGREEMENT that requires a change to the AGREEMENT template, or which does not have a template, is excluded

The following scenarios are approved for Signatory Approvers

- New AGREEMENTS or modifications
- AGREEMENTS for field offices that have the appropriate procurement process, as agreed upon with the CFO
- Event contracts/vendor agreements that are not funded from unrestricted / admin
- AGREEMENTS that do NOT impact office, communications or project technology systems (e.g., websites, email, social media, financial tools)

Note that an agreement may not be split into two or more agreements that are less than or equal to $25,000. Any modifications should be clearly justified as a required change due to extenuating circumstances beyond control of the parties involved with the initial AGREEMENT signature.

### Cover Sheet Approval Procedure

The cover sheet for all AGREEMENTS and CONTRACTS above $25,000 will continue to be signed by the Program Department Directors, the CFO and the President & CEO prior to signing the AGREEMENTS.
All program funded AGREEMENTS and CONTRACTS with the total value of $25,000 and less will be signed by the Program Department Directors and the CFO.



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All the AGREEMENTS and CONTRACTS funded from the indirect budget will be signed by the CFO and the President & CEO regardless of the amount.

Cover sheets shall be processed as follows:

- Sent by COB Wednesday to be signed by the CFO
- Sent to CEO by COB Friday for signature
- Authorization should be sent back to the Department manager by the following Wednesday
- Note that Department managers can begin the AGREEMENT negotiation process with the partners during this process



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# Annex A: Per Diem Examples

[Return]

Examples for calculating per diem for HQ staff
Notes:

- General Services Administration (GSA) establishes per diem rates for destinations within the lower 48 Continental United States (CONUS).
- The Department of Defense (DOD) establishes non-foreign rates which includes Alaska, Hawaii, and all U.S. Territories (Non-CONUS).
- The State Department establishes all foreign rates which are specific to major cities.
- Meal breakdown can be calculated in the following chart (note, for travel funded by USG programs, this table MUST be used): www.gsa.gov/travel/plan-book/per-diem-rates/mie-breakdown

i) Normal example with no exceptions

- Traveler A, a staff from the HQ office, leaves for a trip to New York City on Monday morning in April. The flight is scheduled to leave at 9AM. The traveler returns back to home-of-record on Thursday by noon.
- The M&IE rate is $76, as per the GSA website.
- The Partners' approved rate is 90% = $68.4 (Section 8.2)
- The per diem received will be:
- Monday = $68.4* 75% = $51.80
- Tuesday = $68.40
- Wednesday = $68.40
- Thursday = $68.4 * 75% = $51.80
- Total per diem = $51.80 + $68.40 + $68.40 + $5.1.80 = $240.40

ii) Departing from home early; arriving home late

- Traveler B, a staff from the HQ office, leaves for a trip to Bogota, Colombia on Monday morning in April. The flight is scheduled to leave at 8:00AM. In order to catch the flight, Traveler B must leave the home-of-record at 5:30 AM in order to be at the airport two hours prior to departure. The traveler returns back to home-of-record on Thursday at 10PM.



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- The M&IE rate is $105, as per the State Department website.
- The Partners' approved rate is 90% = $94.50
- The per diem received will be:
- Monday = $94.50 (this is a travel day; however, since Traveler B is leaving the home-of-record before 6AM, as per Section 8.1.2, full per diem is applied)
- Tuesday = $94.50
- Wednesday = $94.50
- Thursday = $94.50 (this is a travel day; however, since Traveler B is arriving to the home-of-record after 7PM, as per Section 8.1.2, full per diem is applied)
- Total per diem = $94.50 + $94.50 + $94.50 + $94.50 = $378

iii) Some meals covered by other sources

- Traveler C, a staff from HQ, attends a conference in Panama City, leaving on flight on Monday at 11AM, attending the conference on Tuesday – Thursday, and returning on Friday morning, arriving to home-of-record after 9PM. During the conference, meals are provided for breakfast and lunch.
- The Panama City M&IE rate is $99, as per the State Department website.
- The Partners' approved rate is 90% = $89.10
- Meal breakdown is as follows, as per Section 8.1.2:
- Breakfast @ the $89.10 = $13; Lunch = $22; Dinner = $36; Incidentals = $18 (numbers rounded to nearest dollar)
- The per diem received will be:
  - Monday = $89.10 * 75% = $66.83 (Panama City is the destination city and the rate to utilize on this first travel day)
  - Tuesday = $36 + $18 = $54 (Dinner plus incidentals)
  - Wednesday = $36 + $18 = $54 (Dinner plus incidentals)
  - Thursday = $36 + $18 = $54 (Dinner plus incidentals)
- Friday = $89.10 (this is a travel day; however, since Traveler C is arriving to the home-of-record after 7PM, as per Section 8.1.2, full per diem is applied; also, Panama City is the city of departure; hence, this rate is utilized)
- Total per diem = $66.83 + 54 + 54 + 54 + 89.10 = $317.93


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# Annex B: Affidavit in lieu of Receipt

[Return]

I certify the following charges are true and correct and made for the business purpose outlined below.

**Purpose/Event:**

| Date | Description | Amount | Payment Method |
|---|---|---|---|

Signed,

_____ _____

Traveler's Name Date



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# Annex C: Travel Report Template

[Return]

(TBD)



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# Annex D: 2 CFR Part 200: Unallowable Costs



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